

Literature

General Lit.
Lit./Mythology





About the Course

Overview note: Literature selections are chosen to encourage students to engage with rich ideas in literature and history and also to help them to gain independence in their reading and lessons.

This course includes the following topic(s): Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6, General Lit.: Grades 5-6

About General Lit.: Grades 5-6

Read living books full of memorable characters, surprising plot twists, and heartwarming endings. Due to the rise of Children's Literature in the 19th century, students read period literature rather than historical fiction this year and will spend about a term and a half each with *Little Women* and *Hans Brinker*.

About Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6

Students read Roman, Norse, and Eastern mythology, Dickens' *A Christmas Carol*, and a selection of short stories and fairy tales written or collected in the 19th century.



Placement & Combining Tips

Literature: Grades 5-6

Overview note: Poetry lessons are an integral part of the whole Literature program, so look at both literature and poetry selections together when placing students.

General Lit.: Grades 5-6

Easily combined with Grade 4.

Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6

Suitable for hungry 4th graders. *A Christmas Carol* and some stories and tales shared with Grades 7-8.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
5-6	General Lit.: Grades 5-6 1 time/week 20 min	<i>Hans Brinker</i> or <i>The Silver Skates</i> <i>Little Women</i>
5-6	Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 1 time/week 25 min	<i>The Age of Fable</i> South American Jungle Tales Russian Fairy Tales <i>A Christmas Carol</i> Short Stories & Folktales

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Literature: Grades 5-6				
Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6		General Lit.: Grades 5-6		



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6

☐ Read the preface and introduction of *The Age of Fable* for background information about myths and the rationale for reading them.

☐ Print "Age of Fable Glossary" for easy access during lessons. Find the link in Quick Links below.

Term Prep & Teacher Tips

Literature: Grades 5-6

The Extra Helping writing prompts in the lessons are used as composition prompts in grades 7-8, and they are only for students who want to dive deeper or experiment with writing at this level.

General Lit.: Grades 5-6

☐ For the *Silver Skates* we have provided two different pacing options for the book depending on your student(s) and context. The first pacing option is slower and better suited for less confident readers reading independently OR those reading the book aloud with their student(s). Note that students will want to finish this book on their own time after the end of the year.

The second pacing option moves more quickly and allows students to finish the book. This is best suited to quick readers or those who want to assign any reading not finished in a lesson for students to complete as homework on their own time during the term.

Regardless of which pacing option you choose, be sure to leave time for students to narrate at the end of the lesson. Note that recap and discussion questions are based on the slower pacing so feel free to skip ahead and use a discussion question from a different lesson if you're following the faster option.

Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6

☐ *The Age of Fable* (Term 1) is best as a read-aloud or assigned as a stretch book for independent reading after the first few lessons are done together. Vocabulary may be difficult to understand, but can be comprehended in context. Reference the glossary in Quick Links as needed. These stories reference imaginary creatures and ancient deities. It is a good idea to think ahead about how you might explain these characters if your students ask.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Literature: Grades 5-6

General Lit.: Grades 5-6



Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates



Little Women

Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6



The Age of Fable



South American Jungle Tales



Russian Fairy Tales



A Christmas Carol

Short Stories & Folktales



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Literature: Grades 5-6

∞ [Foundations \(See Section 9: Literature\)](#)

Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6

∞ [Age of Fable Glossary](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



Literature: Grades 5-6

How To Teach



Prepare

- Read through the lesson and gather any materials or find any necessary links.
- If you have not already read the book, you may want to read the selected pages in advance, especially for Shakespeare lessons. It is helpful to read the play or a preview of it beforehand.
- Choose which books to have students read independently. See Planning and Prep notes for recommendations.



Recap

- Connect back to the previous lesson. Ask students to give a summary of what they remember and/or predict what might come next. (Full narration is not necessary.)
- If students have difficulty recalling, try showing an illustration, sharing something that you remember, or prompting them with the first sentence of the last reading. This will often refresh their memory enough to allow them to recall.
- If students still cannot recall anything from the last reading, then consider continuing anyway (with a shorter reading and/or using a combination of visual and audio support this time) or repeating the last lesson, depending on the reading and the nature of the book.



Introduce

- Use a picture, map, or engaging question to pique the student's interest in the day's lesson.
- If necessary, you may talk about one or two unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding.



Read

- Read the day's passage aloud or have students read independently. For Shakespeare, it is highly recommended that each student have their own copy of the play and that you read it aloud together or read along and underline/make notes while listening to the audio recording.
- Use supportive strategies and educational tools to reduce frustration and better engage the mind, as appropriate. These could include, but are not limited to, the use of eBooks, pictures, audio, read-aloud, buddy reading, colored reading strips, etc.
- Some students may benefit from having a notebook or piece of scrap paper available to externalize ideas by drawing, recording names, or making symbolic 'squiggle' notes.
- Students who have a difficult time sitting still or listening may benefit from: a fidget of their choice, such as a piece of putty or clay or an afghan; flexible positioning, such as a wobble seat or inverted sitting; or sensory modulation, such as a weighted vest or blanket or adjustment of light, temperature, or sound.
- Keep an eye out for things to add to your Book of Centuries, Citizenship Notebook, and Copywork book.



Narrate

- Have students retell the passage orally or in writing. If writing, encourage students to use the full remaining lesson time and include as much detail as they can remember. For Shakespeare or

challenging books, it may be helpful to narrate more frequently and/or use props.

- Alternatively, learners may use words, pictures, legos, dolls, etc. to process and convey ideas in the manner most natural to them.
- Students who used paper or a notebook to externalize may refer to these for support. Other students who need external support may benefit from looking at a map or picture from the book while narrating.
- Students who tend to use the same type of narration all the time, can be encouraged to try another form of narration by first doing it together through play or discussion.
- Teachers may take turns to model.
- Narration is a complex skill that requires the coordination of several parts of the brain. If a student struggles to narrate in general, with a specific subject or book, or on one day but not others, then this is an opportunity to learn. Observe when they struggle with this or any other activity today; notice facial expressions and body language; listen to what they tell about why it is hard or how they feel about it. Take note of these observations for later, tell them that you see how hard they are working, and then offer whatever support they need to end on a positive note or take a break for the day, if necessary.



Discuss

- Give the student an opportunity to share thoughts on the lesson and any connections made.
- To stimulate discussion, you can ask an open-ended question or use an included discussion question.

Literature: Grades 5-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 1

Materials: Little Women

PREP: Read the bio and share parts with your students in the lesson.
∞ Article Link: Louisa May Alcott Bio

→ INTRO

Little Women was published in 2 volumes. We will read Volume 1, published originally in 1868. Little Women was the first American novel written for girls, though it had wide appeal upon publication, with boys and adult women and men as well. It was a move away from overly preachy children's literature and was an immediate success, changing how novels for young people were written.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.1 "Playing Pilgrims"

- If you read Pilgrim's Progress in younger grades, keep an eye out for many different references or allusions to the book as you read Little Women. Did you notice any in this chapter? [Hint: the name of the chapter is one reference!]

★ TEACHER NOTE

See extra helpings for suggested audio versions, as this can be a fun book to listen to in the afternoons or at other times to create flexibility in your schedule.

● IMPORTANT DATES

Little Women published (1868 AD)

WEEK 1 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 1

Adventures of Aeneas and Dido

Materials: Age of Fable

→ INTRO

Virgil wrote the Aeneid between 29 and 19 B.C. We will be reading stories and poetry from this epic work this term.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.31 p.207-213 "We have followed" - "to the Sibyl"

- COMPOSITION - Illustrate & Caption
Phineus and the Harpies or another scene.

WEEK 2 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 2

Materials: Little Women

→ RECAP

Who are the "Little Women" and what is the setting for the book?

→ INTRO

Name as many things as you can that are happening in the world during the late 1800s when Little Women was written and published.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.2 "A Merry Christmas"

- How do the March sisters show joy despite their circumstances?

● EXTRA HELPINGS

∞ Article Link: Christmas During the Civil War

WEEK 2 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 2

Elysium and the Sibyl

Materials: Age of Fable

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.32 p.213-221 "As at the" - "in number less."

- COMPOSITION - Act Out
The meeting of Aeneas and Dido in the land of the dead

Literature: Grades 5-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 3 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 3

Materials: Little Women

→ RECAP

What was Christmas like in the March home?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.3 "The Laurence Boy"

• EXTRA HELPINGS

∞ Article Link: Civil War Dresses

WEEK 3 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 3

Introduction to Infant Rome

Materials: Age of Fable

→ RECAP: WHAT DO YOU REMEMBER ABOUT HOW THE UNDERWORLD WAS DESCRIBED IN THE LAST CHAPTER?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.33 p.221-230 "Aeneas, having parted" - "along the main."

WEEK 4 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 4

Materials: Little Women

→ RECAP

Who did the March sisters meet in the last chapter? What is he like?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.4 "Burdens"

→ VIEW (OPTIONAL)

∞ Link: The Alcotts' Home, which was the inspiration for the Marchs' home.

• Describe some of the burdens the sisters feel they carry. Which seems hardest to you?

WEEK 4 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 4

Pythagoras

Materials: Age of Fable

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.34 p.230-248 "The teachings of" - "were no more."

→ VIEW

Here is a bust of Pythagoras.

∞ Image Link: Pythagoras

• COMPOSITION - Illustrate & Tell
The death of Osiris or another scene.

WEEK 5 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 5

Materials: Little Women

→ RECAP

What are some of the chores or work the sisters are responsible for?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.5 "Being Neighborly"

→ VIEW (OPTIONAL)

∞ Video Link: Transcendentalism and the Alcotts

• EXTRA HELPINGS

Read this memorial poem about Thoreau by Alcott.

∞ Link: Thoreau's Flute

Read about the link between Alcott and Ralph Waldo Emerson in the article linked below.

∞ Article Link: Alcott and Emerson

Literature: Grades 5-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 5	25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 5 <i>Origin of Mythology & The Minerva of the Parthenon</i> Materials: Age of Fable → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.35 p.241-249 "Having reached the" - "fame have immortality." → VIEW Here is one artist's image of Jupiter and a Roman statue of Minerva. ∞ Image Link: Jupiter ∞ Image Link: Minerva	• COMPOSITION - Expository Tell at least three theories on the origins of mythology.
WEEK 6	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 6 Materials: Little Women → RECAP How did Jo show kindness to a neighbor? → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.6-7 "Beth Finds the Palace Beautiful" and "Amy's Valley of Humiliation" • Optional: Have you been noticing the allusions to Pilgrim's Progress? What kind of journey are each of the sisters on, and how is that similar (or dissimilar) to the Pilgrim's journey?	• EXTRA HELPINGS ∞ Video Link: Pickled Limes
WEEK 6	25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 6 <i>Modern Monsters</i> Materials: Age of Fable → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.36 p.250-256 "There is a" - "these sacred fires?"	
WEEK 7	20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 7 Materials: Little Women → RECAP What lesson did Amy learn in the last chapter? → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.8 "Jo Meets Apollyon" • What are some of the lessons about anger and temper in this chapter? Do you agree?	• EXTRA HELPING Pick a scene from the story thus far to turn into a short play.
WEEK 7	25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 7 <i>Eastern Mythology & Siva</i> Materials: Age of Fable → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.37 p.256-264 "Our knowledge of" - "Quiloo and Melind." ∞ Image Link: Brahma ∞ Image Link: Vishnu	

Literature: Grades 5-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 8 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 8

Materials: Little Women

→ RECAP

What lesson did Jo learn in the last chapter?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.9 "Meg Goes to Vanity Fair"

- What temptations does Meg face, and how does she recover?

WEEK 8 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 8

Loki and His Progeny

Materials: Age of Fable

→ INTRO

In the last several years, the popularity of Marvel comic movies has revived the popularity of mythological characters like Thor and Loki.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.38 p.264-269 "The stories" - "long into Niffleheim."

- COMPOSITION - Descriptive
Describe Thor.

WEEK 9 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 9

Materials: Little Women

→ RECAP

What lesson did Meg learn in the last chapter?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.10 "The P.C. and P.O."

- If you wrote something for the Pickwick Portfolio, what would you write?

• EXTRA HELPING

Write up your idea that you discussed in the lesson! Compose an advertisement, article, or poem for the Pickwick Portfolio. You can retell a scene from Little Women or choose something from another book or even your personal experience to write about. One idea: write a newspaper entry about the admission of "Sam Weller" into the club.

WEEK 9 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 9

Thor's Visit to Jotunheim

Materials: Age of Fable

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.39 p.269-275 "Once upon a" - "a verdant plain."

→ VIEW

Look at this runestone, which was carved during the Viking age. The three figures in the center are Odin (with the spear), Thor (with the hammer), and Freyr (with the sickle).

∞ Image Link: Runestone of Norse Mythology

- COMPOSITION - Written
Retelling
Thor's Visit to Jotunheim

WEEK 10 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 10

Materials: Little Women

→ RECAP

Describe the Pickwick Club. Would you want to join?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Literature: Grades 5-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

Ch.11 "Experiments"

- Why do the experiments fail, and what lessons do the girls learn?

WEEK 10 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 10

The Death of Baldur & Ragnarok

Materials: Age of Fable

→ INTRO

It is amazing that these rune stones still can be seen today. Most were engraved during the Viking age, making them around 1,000 years old.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.40 p.276-282 "Baldur the Good" - "by the Northmen!"

WEEK 11 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 11

Materials: Little Women

→ RECAP

What was the "experiment" in the last chapter?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.12 "Camp Laurence"

★ TEACHER NOTE

This is a longer chapter and can be finished in the afternoon or next week during exam week.

WEEK 11 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 11

The Druids

→ INTRO

It is hard to believe some festivals we read about still occur in Scotland today.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.41 p.282-288 "The Druids were" - "but witness mine!"

WEEK 12 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 12

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:

Little Women

★ TEACHER NOTE

Finish chapter from last week as needed.

WEEK 12 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 12

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:

Age of Fable

Literature: Grades 5-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 1 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 13

Materials: Little Women

→ INTRO

What does your "dream future" look like 5 or 10 years from now?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.13 "Castles in the Air"

• EXTRA HELPING

Write a profile or character sketch of one of the sisters. What are they like? Write as if you were telling a friend about them.

WEEK 1 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 13

WEEK 2 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 14

Materials: Little Women

→ RECAP

What were some of the sisters' dreams in the previous chapter?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Beginning of Ch.14 "Secrets" - "Saying she would call her mother" p.253 (middle of Ch.15)

- How does Alcott use the contrasting personalities of the sisters as foils? A foil is when an author contrasts two characters to emphasize some of their qualities. The word foil refers to backing gems with foil to make them shine brighter.

→ VIEW (OPTIONAL)

With the remaining time or in the afternoon, learn more about the telegraph.

∞ Video Link: The Telegraph: The Civil War Text Machine

• IMPORTANT DATES

Telegraph invented (1830s)

• EXTRA HELPINGS

∞ Video Link: LMA, Civil War Nurse

WEEK 2 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 14

WEEK 3 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 15

Materials: Little Women

→ INTRO

What does good comfort look and feel like? What are ways you've been comforted when sad or ways that people have tried to comfort you unhelpfully?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.15 p.253 "Everything was arranged" - end of Ch.16 "Letters"

• EXTRA HELPING

Write a letter to Jo comforting her during Beth's illness.

★ TEACHER NOTE

Beth likely had Scarlet Fever. Share from or view this short video as desired.

∞ Video Link: Scarlet Fever

WEEK 3 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 15

WEEK 4 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 16

Materials: Little Women

→ RECAP

What do you think will happen next?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.17-18 "Little Faithful" & "Dark Days"

- Make a character chart of Amy's virtues versus her vanities.

WEEK 4 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 16

Literature: Grades 5-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 5 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 17

Materials: Little Women

→ RECAP

How did the sisters show care for others in the previous chapters?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.19-20 "Amy's Will" & "Confidential"

- In what ways did Alcott use the literary device of foreshadowing leading up to Beth's illness? Foreshadowing is when an author gives us hints or clues about what might happen later in the story.

* In what ways does Little Women show that life can be good even through trials and tragedies?

• EXTRA HELPINGS

Tell about Amy's will from Laurie's point of view, being sure to include what he might have been thinking.

∞ **Article Link:** Autobiographical Roots of Little Women

WEEK 5 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 17

WEEK 6 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 18

Materials: Little Women

→ RECAP

Describe what you've learned about Amy.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.21 "Laurie Makes Mischief, and Jo Makes Peace"

- Were you satisfied with the resolution of the prank in this chapter? Why or why not? If not, how might you have resolved it differently?

• EXTRA HELPING

In Ch.21 Jo says, "'Hold your tongue!'...I came here to moralize, not to hear about things that make me skip to think of." Explain why you think she said this.

WEEK 6 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 18

WEEK 7 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 19

Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ INTRO

Following the Civil War, the American public was in dire need of a pleasant distraction. Hans Brinker offered this escape and became an instant bestseller, second only to Charles Dickens in sales. Mary Mapes Dodge made a lasting change in children's literature both as the author of Hans Brinker and editor of St. Nicholas magazine. She brought some of the finest writers of her day to young readers and helped make writing for children lively, thoughtful, and full of imagination.

This story is set in Holland. The Netherlands is the official name of the entire country, while Holland makes up two provinces within the country - North and South Holland. Optional: View Holland on this map (Scroll down to see the map.)

∞ Map Link: The Netherlands

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.1-2

OR

Ch.1-3

- What have you already learned about Holland?

★ TEACHER NOTE

Choose which pacing option to follow based on your student(s)' ability and interest. See Planning & Prep notes for more details on each option.

• TERMINOLOGY

∞ **Article Link:** Hans Brinker Pronunciation & corrections (shared with permission)

• EXTRA HELPINGS

Click "See More" near the top of this page to read a short bio of the author.

∞ **Article Link:** Mary Mapes Dodge bio

WEEK 7 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 19

Literature: Grades 5-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 8 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 20

Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ MAPWORK

Use your atlas or view this map and find the capital city of Amsterdam. You may want to print the map and tuck it in the book to refer to as you read.

∞ Map Link: Netherlands Map

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.3-4

OR

Ch.4-6

- How would you describe Hans and Gretel to a friend?

• EXTRA HELPINGS

∞ Video Link: Dutch Windmill Inside

WEEK 8 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 20

WEEK 9 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 21

Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ RECAP

How did Hans and Gretel find a friend?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.5-7

OR

Ch.7-9

- What “shadows” hang over the Brinker home?

• EXTRA HELPINGS

∞ Video Link: Traditional Dutch Winter Skating

WEEK 9 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 21

WEEK 10 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 22

Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ RECAP

What do you remember about Hans and Gretel's parents?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.8-9

OR

Ch.10-11

- What does the boys’ plan to skate nearly fifty miles reveal about them and the time they live in?

→ VIEW

St. Nicholas illustration from St. Nicholas magazine, where Mary Mapes Dodge served as editor.

∞ Image Link: St. Nicholas Illustration

• LITERATURE CONNECTION

Louisa May Alcott (of Little Women fame) wrote for the St. Nicholas magazine!

WEEK 10 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 22

WEEK 11 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 23

Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ RECAP

What do you think will happen next?

• EXTRA HELPINGS

Virtually browse some of the art mentioned in this chapter if time allows.

∞ Link: Rijksmuseum Art

Literature: Grades 5-6

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Term 2	
→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.10-11 OR Ch.12-15 • How do Dutch customs of the Saint Nicholas celebration compare to your own Christmas celebrations?	
WEEK 11 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 23	
WEEK 12 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 24 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course.	
WEEK 12 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 24 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course.	



Term 3

WEEK 1 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 25

Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ RECAP

What do you remember about the Saint Nicholas celebrations?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.12-13

OR

Ch.16-18

→ MAPWORK

Use your atlas or view this map and find Haarlem.

∞ Map Link: Netherlands Map

- How would you have responded to the "catastrophe" if you had been with the boys?

WEEK 1 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 25

Materials: A Christmas Carol

→ INTRO

A Christmas Carol is a novella, which is longer than a short story but shorter than a novel. It was published on December 19, and the first edition sold out by Christmas Eve, making it an immediate success. Like much of Dickens' writing, the story is a commentary on the social problems of his era, such as poverty, child welfare, and poor working conditions.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.1-11 Beginning to "closed it with a bang"

- Why do you think Scrooge dislikes Christmas so much?

★ TEACHER NOTE

See extra helpings for suggested audio versions, as this can be a fun book to listen to. Feel free to move reading this book closer to Christmas.

• IMPORTANT DATES

A Christmas Carol published (1843 AD)

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Video Link: Life In A Victorian Workhouse

WEEK 2 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 26

Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ RECAP

What happened in the catastrophe? What do you think will happen next?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.14-15

OR

Ch.19-21

- What different kinds of homes are described?
- Why does Gretel struggle with her feelings about her father?

• EXTRA HELPINGS

∞ Video Link: Historic Dutch Home Tour

WEEK 2 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 26

Materials: A Christmas Carol

→ RECAP

How would you describe Scrooge so far?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.11-21 "The sound resounded" - "Upon the instant" (end of stave one)

- * Why does Scrooge try so hard to explain away Marley's ghost?

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Article Link: How A Christmas Carol Became A Holiday Classic

Literature: Grades 5-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 3 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 27

Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ RECAP

What do you remember about the Brinker home?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.16-17

OR

Ch.22-23

- Why do you think the author includes so many details about the places the boys visit?

WEEK 3 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 27

Materials: A Christmas Carol

→ RECAP

What do you think will happen next?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.22-32 Beginning of Stave two - "Upon a winter's night"

- * What was Christmas like when Scrooge was young?

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Article Link: 10 Things To Know about Charles Dickens' Christmas Carol

WEEK 4 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 28

Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ RECAP

What was the meaning of the "man with four heads"?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.18-19

OR

Ch.24-26

- What dangers or freedoms come with spending so much time on the ice?

• EXTRA HELPINGS

∞ Video Link: Can a finger really be used to stop a leaky dike?

WEEK 4 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 28

Materials: A Christmas Carol

→ RECAP

What mood was Scrooge in when we left off? Notice how his mood changes through stave two.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.32-39 "In came a fiddler" - end of Stave two

- * Why were the scenes with Belle so painful for Scrooge?

• EXTRA HELPING

Compare Scrooge and Fezziwig as employers. What do the actions of each show about leadership and responsibility for your employees?

∞ Video Link: Why Read Charles Dickens?

WEEK 5 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 29

Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ RECAP

What happened last on the canal?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

★ TEACHER NOTE

The next lesson includes an optional video for traditional Dutch gingerbread. (A five ingredient quick bread.) Look ahead and gather ingredients if you would like to make your own.

Literature: Grades 5-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

Ch.20-21
OR
Ch.27-28

- How do group plans reveal who is flexible, selfish, cautious, or brave?

WEEK 5 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 29

Materials: A Christmas Carol

→ RECAP

What did the Ghost of Christmas Past show Scrooge?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.40-51 Stave three - "Blushed to hint at such a thing"

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Video Link: Charles Dickens home tour

WEEK 6 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 30

Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ RECAP

What do you remember about the Red Lion so far?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.22-23

OR

Ch.29-32

→ VIEW (OPTIONAL)

With the remaining time or in the afternoon, learn how to make traditional Dutch Gingerbread.

∞ Video Link: Traditional Dutch Gingerbread

- How does the author mix comedy and danger? Why do you think she chose to do that?

WEEK 6 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 30

Materials: A Christmas Carol

→ RECAP

What did Scrooge learn by visiting the Cratchit family?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.51-64 "At last the dinner" - end of Stave three

- * What do you think the children Ignorance and Want represent?

• EXTRA HELPING

The Ghost of Christmas Present shows Scrooge two suffering children named Ignorance and Want. What do these children represent, and why do you think Dickens showed them in such a shocking way?

∞ Video Link: Dickens London

WEEK 7 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 31

Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ RECAP

How did the Red Lion become dangerous? What was the resolution?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.24-25

OR

Ch.33-36

→ MAPWORK

Use your atlas or view this map and find Leiden (Leyden is an older spelling).

• EXTRA HELPINGS

The "Egyptian Museum" is likely the Rijksmuseum van Oudheden.

∞ Link: Rijksmuseum van Oudheden

Literature: Grades 5-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

∞ Map Link: Netherlands Map

- How can visiting museums help us better understand the people, history, and culture of a place?

WEEK 7 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 31

📄 Materials: A Christmas Carol

→ RECAP

What ghosts have visited Scrooge so far? Who do you think will visit next?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.65-76 Stave four - "there is your father at the door"

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Video Link: The Story of A Christmas Carol and Victorian England

WEEK 8 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 32

📄 Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ RECAP

What did the boys see in Leyden?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.26-27

OR

Ch.37-40

- How does the quote "it is no sin to love beautiful things if you adapt your material to circumstances" help us think about enjoying beauty wisely?

WEEK 8 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 32

📄 Materials: A Christmas Carol

→ RECAP

What do you think will happen next?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.76-89 "She hurried out" - end of stave five.

→ VIEW (OPTIONAL)

∞ Video Link: How A Christmas Carol Perfectly Demonstrates 5-Act Structure (Note that this is the same structure as many of Shakespeare's plays.)

WEEK 9 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 33

📄 Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ RECAP

What stories were shared in the last lesson?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.28-29

OR

Ch.41-42

→ MAPWORK

Use your atlas or view this map and find The Hague.

∞ Map Link: Netherlands Map

- Why is a day of rest important in the story?

• EXTRA HELPINGS

∞ Video Link: The Hague Market today.

Literature: Grades 5-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 9 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 33

WEEK 10 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 34

Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ **RECAP**

What happened during the visit to The Hague?

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

Ch.30-31

OR

Ch.43-44

- As they head home, what has changed because of their journey?

WEEK 10 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 34

WEEK 11 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 35

Materials: Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ **RECAP**

What happened as the boys head home?

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

Ch.32-33

OR

Ch.45-48

- Why is it sometimes difficult to hope when a situation feels uncertain?
- How can friendship help someone going through tough times?

WEEK 11 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 35

WEEK 12 20m General Lit.: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 36

Exam Week

→ **EXAMS**

Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from:
Hans Brinker or The Silver Skates

→ **READ & DISCUSS**

Ch.34-35

OR

Finish the book over exam week as needed.

• **EXTRA HELPINGS**

∞ **Video Link:** Elfstedentocht:
The Famed Frozen Race

WEEK 12 25m Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6 - Lesson 36

Exam Week

→ **EXAMS**

Answer question(s) related to course.

Literature: Grades 5-6

Examination

Term 1

Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6

- In writing or picture, describe a scene from the adventures of Aeneas OR the story of Isis and Osiris.
- Describe Ragnarok in words or pictures.

General Lit.: Grades 5-6

- Little Women: Pilgrim's Progress is referred to multiple times in the book. Explain Jo's Apollyon in Ch.8, Meg's Vanity Fair in Ch.9, or discuss other parallels to Pilgrim's Progress that you've seen.

Term 2

General Lit.: Grades 5-6

- Act out one of your favorite scenes from Little Women.

Term 3

Lit./Mythology: Grade 5-6

- Explain how Scrooge changes from the beginning to the end of A Christmas Carol. What helps him change the most? Use examples from the story.

General Lit.: Grades 5-6

- Hans Brinker: Explain two ways that Hans and Gretel show responsibility and care for their family. What do their actions tell us about the kind of people they are? OR Describe two places the boys visit during their trip and explain what they see or experience at each one.